CB6 Transportation, Parks, Public Infrastructure, & Public Safety Committee Meeting
Wednesday, November 19, 6:30 pm

AGENDA
[12 members: quorum, 3 on zoom, 9 in-person]

1. Updates on recent resolutions
2. Areas for future transportation infrastructure upgrades (ask committee members for suggestions)
    a. 2nd St Bike Boulevard, and 3rd st betw 4th and 5th
    b. Addition of red light cameras and speed cameras, places like Columbia Street, Hicks and Atlantic
    c. 8th ave before Union St. traffic piles up — make Union St one way? Remove parking?
    d. Restore a bus between Park Slope and Carroll Gardens — old B71 route
        i. This could feed into the BK Bus Network Redesign — we should host a community session!
    e. Priorities from District Needs Survey: Atlantic, 4th Av Flatbush to 20th St, Red Hook routes,
    f. Retail space in 4th Av & 9th St Station
    g. 5th Av, Bergen and Dean St safety
    h. Commercial loading zones: 2nd ave (between 8th & 10th street as an example)
    i. Northbound protected lane to complement Court St. (Clinton Street, add protected lane)
    j. Hicks Street trench “decking” it over, what is the status of this plan?
    k. Improved lighting infrastructure, especially on sidewalks for pedestrian safety
        i. Improve pedestrian infrastructure broadly, more pedestrian islands, etc.
3. Discussion of how we can document street safety conditions to inform future infrastructure and enforcement priorities
    a. Partner with an advocacy organization, use 311 data, or do it ourselves?
    b. Parking regulations, red light cameras, blocked crosswalks, all issues that are reported to 311 and enforcement is lacking
    c. NYPD does not seem to have an interest in changing policy
    d. Is there a more centralized way to collect this information? Community board site where pictures/occurrences can be dropped?
    e. Send 311 requests to Mike (district manager: mike@bkcb6.org), this can then be compiled and there would be follow-up action
        i. Compiling 311 requests would help build a case for enforcement
    f. Manhattan has more towing than Brooklyn, do we have a tow truck deficit at precincts?
    g. “Quality teams” through NYPD respond to 311 calls
    h. Document problem points, red light blocking, double parking, people driving the wrong way; “super-sized” 311 complaint to identify problem areas
    i. Parking enforcement back under DOT??? May improve enforcement experiences

j. Can we partner with students at urban planning schools to study some of the issues that we are interested in getting more data about?
    i. Cheaper than a DOT worker and possibly more timely
k. Wholesale suppliers offer discounts for overnight deliveries, higher delivery fees during the day to make up for congestion pricing. The systems are trickling down, as a business owner it's better to have deliveries overnight and is better for everyone (better for drivers and business owners).

Community input

- Cops going down the bike lane, school drop-off, are there enough commercial loading zones?
- Is it possible to expand commercial loading hours?
- 8th Avenue & Union Street, quiet going Westbound from the park down – can it be one-way for cars?
    - DOT maybe had issues with this and CB6 voted this down
- Concerns about disabled and older adults who need curbside access (can they use commercial loading zones for pick-ups and drop-offs?)

4. Consider a resolution in support of Intro 1380 prohibiting the sale of Class 3 e-bikes with a top speed of over 20 mph.
    a. Proposed resolution text:
    CB6 supports Intro 1380, the Ride Safe, Ride Right bill sponsored by Council Members Crystal Hudson, Alexa Avilés, and others. This bill prohibits the sale or rental of e-bikes with a top speed of over 20 mph. We also encourage the Mayor's office to return to a speed limit of 20 mph for e-bikes in NYC, to establish one clear standard for the legal purchase and operation of micromobility vehicles in NYC. We reiterate our support for Sammy's Law.
    b. Discussion:
        i. Is there a way to switch the language from e-bike to "throttle-powered"?
            1. This would be supporting the law, so it would need to match whatever language the city council used.
        ii. Community boards are advisory, it's positive for the council and councilmembers who support this law to have community support around this.
        iii. Can make a motion to append onto this if we feel we need to make a change.
        iv. There are already laws that exist that prohibit certain speed limits for e-bikes, but there is no enforcement as it is.
            1. There are fines built into the law re: enforcement.
        v. How quickly can e-bikes get to 20 mph?
        vi. Does the law define what an e-bike is?
            1. The law says it would prohibit class 3 bicycles…

vii. Very confusing without a standard that matches the bike speed that you purchased, which is why 20 mph is an important marker.
viii. Speed and size of vehicles contribute to injuries, citywide people have made peace with losing hundreds of people a year by cars, but we can do better than this. The data proves that hundreds of people in New York City are injured or killed every year. Speed limits writ large should be lowered, especially for cars.
ix. Add an addendum to the resolution that reminds the council that CB6 supports Sammy's Law, limiting the speed of cars in addition to e-bikes.
x. ?? Motion. Dillon/Madelaine second. Leroy abstained for cause. Motion carries unanimously.

5. Plans for future meetings
    a. DOT updates on Court St. bike lane when complete
        i. They will not return until the lawsuit is complete.
    b. Presentation from 5th Av BID
    c. Follow up on Low Traffic Neighborhoods (resolution passed both committee and full board meeting in November): how do we move towards an actionable proposal?
    d. Member suggestions
        i. How to manage requests from the community for DOT presentations/actions?
        ii. DOT needs $$ for comprehensive studies (happening now in Red Hook)
6. Community comment [**2 min or less per person**]
    a. E-bikes and Citibikes, if someone gets injured, how are they held accountable? How many bikes (motorcycles included) cause injuries?
    b. DeGraw is a narrow street: too many semitrucks, double parking, cars parked at fire hydrants, no enforcement
        i. Hard daylighting would make this a lot better
    c. Love the Court Street bike lane, "game changing"
    d. Gowanus has a chronic sidewalk parking problem, 3rd Ave between 7th & 8th, Baltic, etc.
        i. Filed 311 complaints, both before the Quality Teams and after, the 7-8 precinct has taken *some* action, but mostly none. No summons issued against license plates when checked later. What is the solution?
    e. Speed limit can only be lowered to 20 or 15 mph. Is there any state control over speed limit for bikes and e-bikes like there is for car speed limits?
        i. City rule was 20 mph for e-bikes and anything you don't need a license for until Eric Adams lowered it to 15 mph last month.
        ii. State has different classes with different speeds that they're allowed to operate at. Class 3 tops out at 25 mph.
    f. Increased honking, sirens, etc on Court Street; e-bikes stop for pedestrians, cyclists just go.
    g. Sammy's Law, would love to see speed limits lowered on every block in the area. What recommendation did CB6 make and what is next?

    i. Sammy's Law is law, but it's only as far as specific streets. DOT investigates what streets should have lower speed limits.

h. What standards are Citibike riders held to?